

Theme-4 - Perceived consequences: financial, identity and reputational harm.

⇒ Sub-categories: fear of money loss, worry about identity theft and misuse of photos/videos, concern about being implicated in crimes or losing social standing.

Summary: The strongest motivators for security are risk perceptions - especially financial and reputational harms.

Theme-5 - Awareness gaps, trust issues, & barriers to better security.

⇒ Sub-categories: Never heard of password managers, distrust in password managers and providers, time-cost of 2FA, desire for stronger policy.

Summary: Low awareness and distrust are major barriers. Even when workers know tools exist, many avoid them due to perceived complexity or fear that the tool itself could be compromised.

5. Links for our worked dataset are already attached to the drive.

6. Summary paragraph - high-level takeaways:

Indian mTurk workers in this dataset respond to account/device compromise primarily with practical, reactive actions and rely on provider recovery.

while many adopt device-level protections, substantial awareness gaps and distrust persist regarding password managers and centralized security tools. The main motivators for adopting security behaviors are concrete financial & reputational risks, while the main barriers are perceived complexity, time costs and lack of trust.

Theme-1 — Reactive mitigation & institutional reporting: Across responses, workers repeatedly described contacting police or file complaints as a core reaction to theft: "I JUST CALLED THE CUSTOMER CARE AND BLOCKED MY SIM THEN I REGISTERED A COMPLAINT IN POLICE STATION" (row 4). Many noted contacting the platform provider (Amazon support for mTurk restores, Google recover flows) as central to getting accounts back. This suggests a reliance on formal institutions and service providers workers often prioritize these avenues over preventative investments (e.g. adopting password managers). The presence of police/FIR as a routine step indicates that workers consider legal recourse both a practical recovery step and a deterrent.

Theme-2 — Practical coping strategies & tool adoption: Practical device-level tools (Find my device, SIM blocking) are widely known & used. Several respondents described precisely using Android Device Manager or remote wipe and immediately blocking SIMs and cards. OTP and SIM-based protections are frequently credited with preventing monetary loss ("due to the otp option i did not lose any money"). Authenticator apps such as Google Authenticator

and Anthey appeared in multiple responses as trusted 2nd factors. This indicates workers prefer tools that produce an immediate, tangible action or outcome.

Theme-3 — Password practices & mixed attitudes about password managers:

Password practices are heterogeneous: some workers memorize complex patterns & prefer diaries (e.g., "I keep a physical diary and have written passwords in code-word form.") while others already use password managers and see them as valuable. However, distrust is common: "I do not trust the password managers. I keep a physical diary" (row 12); "storing all my password in password manager is giving too much information to my password managers. If it gets hack then I might be in a huge trouble" (row 6). This split indicates two groups: those who accept central tools for convenience/security, and those who prefer personal control & low-tech solutions due to fear the tool itself could be a single point of failure.

Theme-4 — Perceived consequences: financial, identity, and reputational harms:

Financial loss is the dominant fear — stories of credit card misuse, unauthorized purchases and worries about bank accounts appear throughout. Identity theft & reputational harms (misuse of photos or being implicated in crimes) are also salient. A strong emotional response is present: one respondent described being arrested due to misuse of photos & needing to prove innocence. These perceived harms are strong motivators for both reactive behavior (blocking cards, billing complaints) and proactive behavior (choosing stronger passwords, using 2FA).

Theme-5 - Awareness gaps, trust issues, & barriers to better security:

Many respondents had never heard of password managers or were unsure what 2FA is. For others, friction-2FA is "too tedious" - and distrust of institutions stopped adoption. Several asked for systemic solutions: "A common international policy should be made to protect users data." This suggests that interventions should target both knowledge and trust (transparent tools) & minimize friction to encourage adoption.

Example quotes:

- ① "My mTurk account was hacked last month... after a week mTurk account hacked case personal, social, financial" - Emphasizes real-world business impact & recovery cost.
- ② "I have never heard about it [password manager]" - indicates awareness gaps.
- ③ "I use Google authenticator and Authy because it enhances security" - shows trust in authenticator apps versus password managers.

7. Personas: We are using the mTurk datasets.

8. Persona 1 - Rina Sen (The Cautious Novice)

Age/Role: 27, part-time mTurk worker & student (Bengaluru).

Background: Works flexible hours doing microtasks to supplement income. Has moderate smartphone literacy but limited formal IT training. Uses a single smartphone for work and personal life.

Goals: Secure her income sources, avoid time-consuming recovery processes, keep personal photos private, avoid social embarrassment.

Tech habits & security practices:

- Memorizes passwords with a simple pattern & sometimes writes hints in a physical notebook.
- Uses SMS OTP for banking but is not using an authenticator app.
- Has never used a password manager, not sure what one does.

Attitudes & concerns:

- Strong fear of losing money or being implicated in wrongdoing if accounts get hacked.
- Distrustful of third-party password managers — worries they might be hacked.
- Will call customer care & file police complaints if compromised.

Needs & pain points:

- Easy, low-friction security tools; simple step-by-step help for recovery.
- Clear explanations that password managers are safe & how they reduce risk.

Frictional personal details:

~~Enjoys~~ Enjoys photography, moderate social media use (private profile), helps younger siblings with school.

Design implications: Rina needs frictionless tools (one-click 2FA setup), simple educational nudges.

and reassurance about trustworthy password storage.

Persona 2 — Rahul Mehra (The Security Pragmatist)

Age/Role : 36 full-stack developer, full-time mTusk worker (Gurgaon).

Background : Has technical training, understands security concepts, sometimes does bug-hunting tasks on mTusk. Experienced account recovery (had accounts hacked previously but regained access through support).

Goals : Minimize downtime from compromise, protect business contacts and client trust, keep financial accounts safe.

Tech habits & security practices:

- uses a password manager & 2FA (Google Authentication)
- keeps backups & uses device tracking.
- Regularly updates passwords & uses different passwords across important accounts.

Attitudes & concerns:

- Pragmatic: trusts proven tools (Authenticator apps) but still wary of centralization risks.
- Will engage providers & police when needed, but prefers to avoid such incidents through preventive measures.

Needs & pain points:

- Professional-grade recovery aids and clear instructions for legal recourse in India.
- Transparent tools that support export/backups of password vaults.

Fictional personal details: Married, occasionally teaches part-time workshops on web development, values control and autonomy.

Design implications: Rahul benefits from advanced, configurable security options and clear protocols for recovery and incident reporting.

9. Reflections:

Qualitative coding — usefulness & limits:

→ Strengths: Inductive coding revealed nuanced patterns (e.g., distrust in password managers) & allowed grouping of practical behaviors vs. attitudes. It surfaced both actions and rationales (fear-driven behaviors), which quantitative measures would miss.

→ Weaknesses: The data is self-reported and sparse in places — some responses are short, limiting depth. Coding subjective responses can introduce researcher bias; multiple coders & intercoder reliability would strengthen the findings.

Personas — usefulness & limits :

→ Strengths : Personas synthesize insights into actionable archetypes for design (e.g: low-tech novices vs security-savvy pragmatists). They make it easier to prioritize features and educational strategies.

→ Weaknesses : Personas are simplified and may over-generalize; they risk masking within-group diversity. They should be validated by further interviews or surveys.

10. Team Work Breakdown :

Ebbat Jahan Ema (ID: 0122520030) : Consolidated codes into 15-20, developed clustering diagram, wrote themes and narrative part.

Md. Ahsan Kabir (ID: 0122520016) : Data copying initial read-through, first-cycle coding, selected quotes, drafted personas & reflections.

Joint : Reviewed the final text, edited for clarity and prepared the final report.
We balanced work by assigning coding and analysis stages, then cross-reviewing each other's output to check consistency & reduce bias.